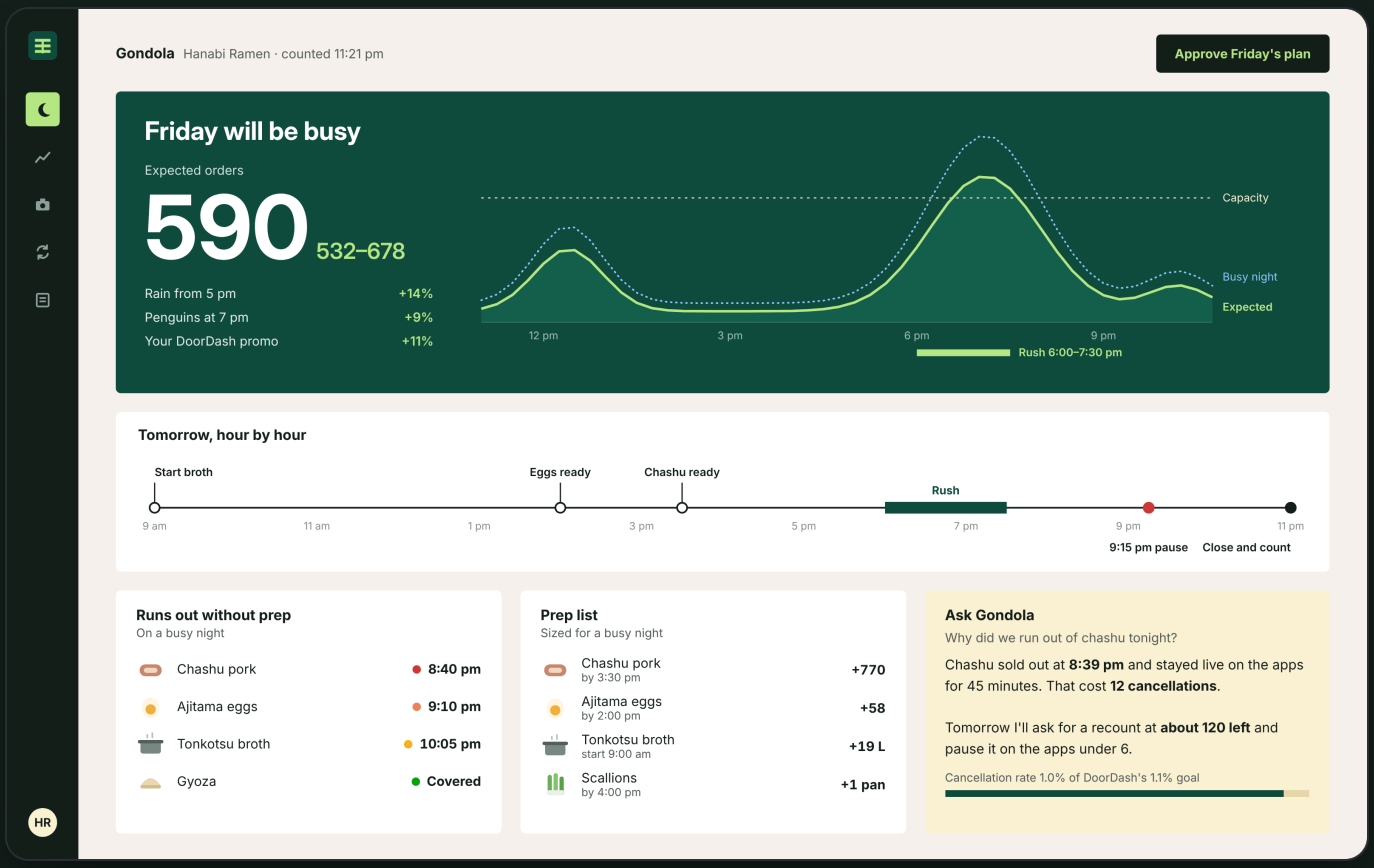
Gondola

Tonight's close preps tomorrow's rush

One button closes the day. When the manager taps Close shift, Gondola's agents check the money, explain the day, plan tomorrow's prep and when to pause each item on the apps, write the Daily Close Report and send one text when something is urgent.

Hackathon submission · Carnegie Mellon, Pittsburgh | Track: Back House | Python + Google ADK



INTRODUCTION & INSPIRATION

DoorDash's AI gets merchants orders. Nothing helps them survive the rush

On our call, the DoorDash reps walked through the AI tools merchants already have: onboarding that scrapes their website (about 35% faster), photo editing and a shoppable video library in the Merchant Portal, AI-built websites, and an AI Marketer that brings back past customers. Every one of them creates demand. Then came the question we couldn't stop thinking about:

> **"How can we make AI help merchants during peak hours? After close, merchants still need to count the stock, fill the schedule, and reconcile the books."**

What we found

We researched why rushes overwhelm merchants. Peak hour plays out in three stages (orders arrive, the kitchen fills, Dashers arrive), and the most damaging failure is set up the night before.

7 pm
busiest hour in 16 of 17 US metros; delivery stacks on top of dine-in
Toast · vendor

~5×
longer waits when a kitchen goes from 80% to 95% of capacity
Kingman queueing formula

28.6%
of cancellations in the last hour, which has 18% of orders
Otter · vendor

<1.1%
DoorDash avoidable-cancellation goal; out-of-stock counts against it
DoorDash Help

The rush burns through prep

Rain, a Penguins game or a promo pushes demand past what the kitchen planned for. Items sell out mid-service but stay live on DoorDash, Uber Eats and Grubhub, and each order becomes a cancellation the store is scored on.

After close is all guesswork

Owners count stock on clipboards (vendors estimate 4–6 hours a week) and size tomorrow's prep from memory. A single store's history can't anticipate weather, games or promos on its own.

Our insight

The close is when everything scattered (sales reports, payouts, invoices, cash, stock) finally stops moving, and the night before is the only moment an owner can still change tomorrow's rush. If one tap at close turned all of it into answers and a plan, owners would stop doing a second shift of paperwork and stop losing orders to things they could have seen coming.

SOLUTION

What is Gondola

Gondola is an agentic close-out copilot for DoorDash merchants. It connects through the store's POS or ordering middleware, which already carries every DoorDash, Uber Eats and Grubhub order. When the manager taps Close shift, its agents turn the day's scattered records into a checked report, tomorrow's plan and one urgent text, then protect the next service.

What one tap of Close shift does

BOOKS
Get paid right
Cash tonight; each app verified when its report lands.

→

STOCK
What's left
Leftover portions of 3–8 limited items, confirmed.

→

ANALYZE
How today went
Against a usual day and similar days.

→

PLAN
Tomorrow
A card: prep per item and when to pause it per app.

→

REPORT
Tell you
2-page PDF, email, one urgent text, answers on demand.

Three ways to know your stock (video is optional)

Demand forecasting never needs video: it runs on sales history. At every close the manager confirms leftover portions of 3–8 limited items; the ingredient ledger and video are optional upgrades.

History only
Forecast mode
Merchant connects their POS, or uploads DoorDash Report Builder exports (up to 2 years). Gondola forecasts tomorrow and suggests prep from usual par levels.

- Setup in minutes
- No recipes or counts needed

+ recipes and invoices
Ledger mode
An optional running estimate per ingredient. Weekly counts can't catch over-portioning, so Guard runs on confirmed portion counts.

- Recipes entered once
- Invoices parsed by photo or email

+ video count
Verified mode
A 60-second walk-in video, nightly or weekly, resets the estimate to what's really there and shows waste and over-portioning.

- Highest accuracy, variance explained
- Video only, microphone off

```
# Ledger mode, per ingredient
on_hand = last_count
        + received  # invoices
        − sold × recipe
        − logged waste
```

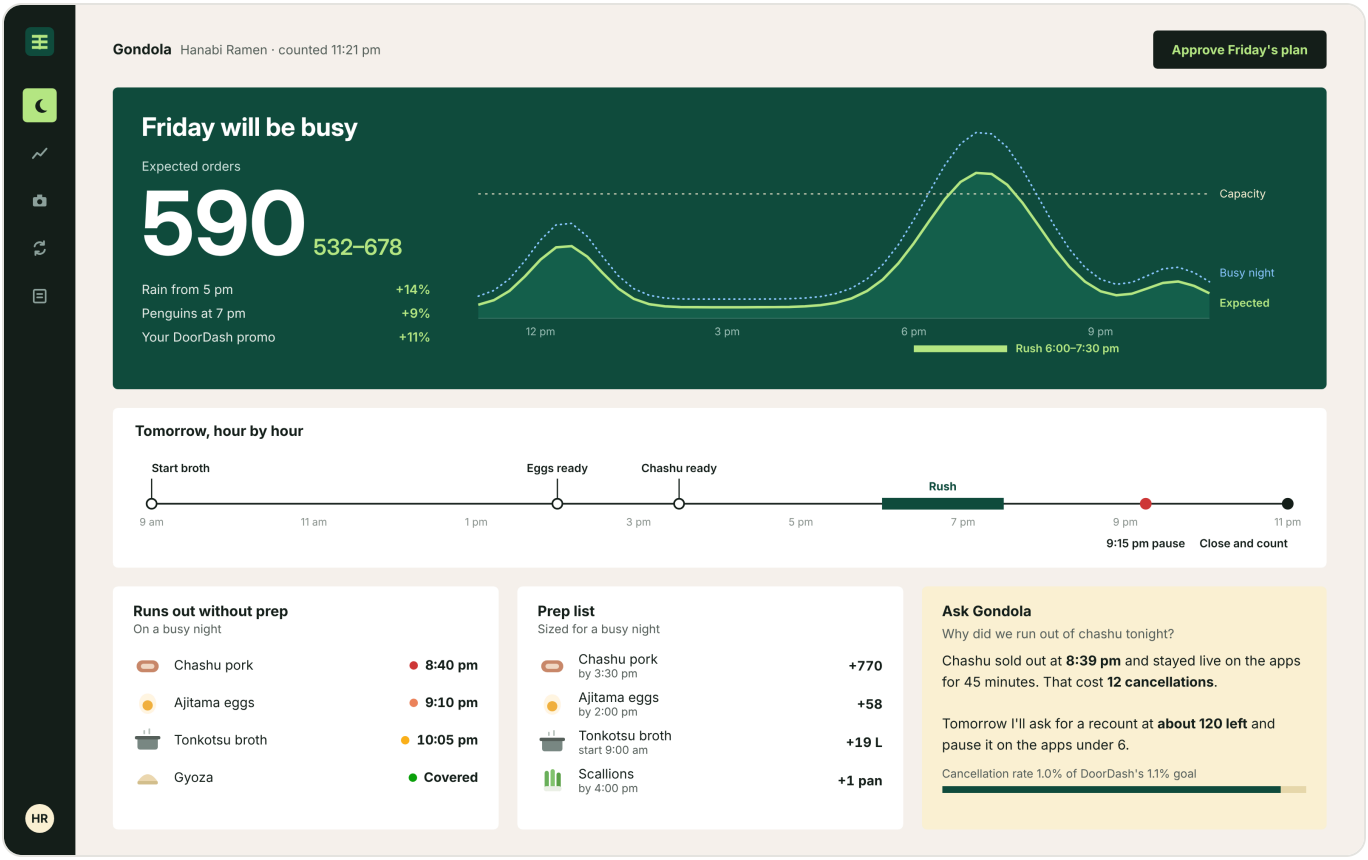
How it connects

DoorDash likely allows one integration per store, usually the POS or middleware (Square, Toast, Clover, Deliverect, Otter), so we'll confirm with DoorDash. It bans third-party Merchant Portal logins and dispute filing, so Gondola never does either. It reads orders through the store's system. Pausing an item on the apps needs partner access; the demo uses DoorDash test stores (if access is granted) and the Square sandbox.

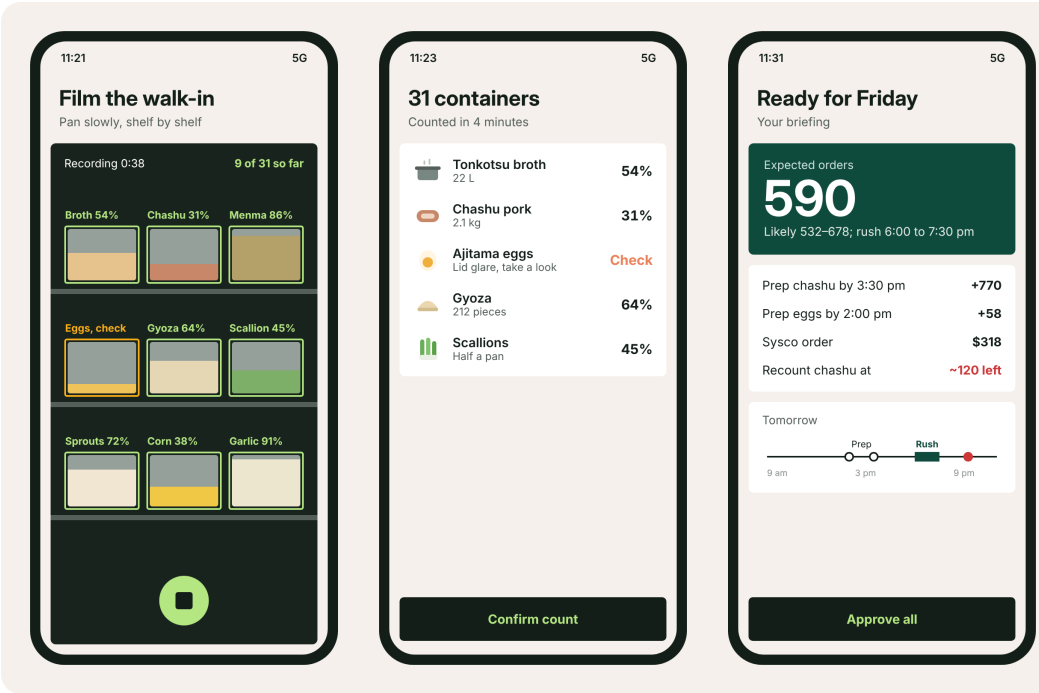
Why one close, not five tools: Square Managerbot recaps the day, Loop and Voosh chase disputes, Tenzo sends an end-of-day report, ClearCOGS forecasts prep. Gondola runs all of it from one tap at close, across every app, and decides *when* to pause an item before it sells out instead of after.

THE PRODUCT

One screen before you lock up



Owner dashboard · fictional restaurant · demo-night forecast; drivers and prep times illustrative

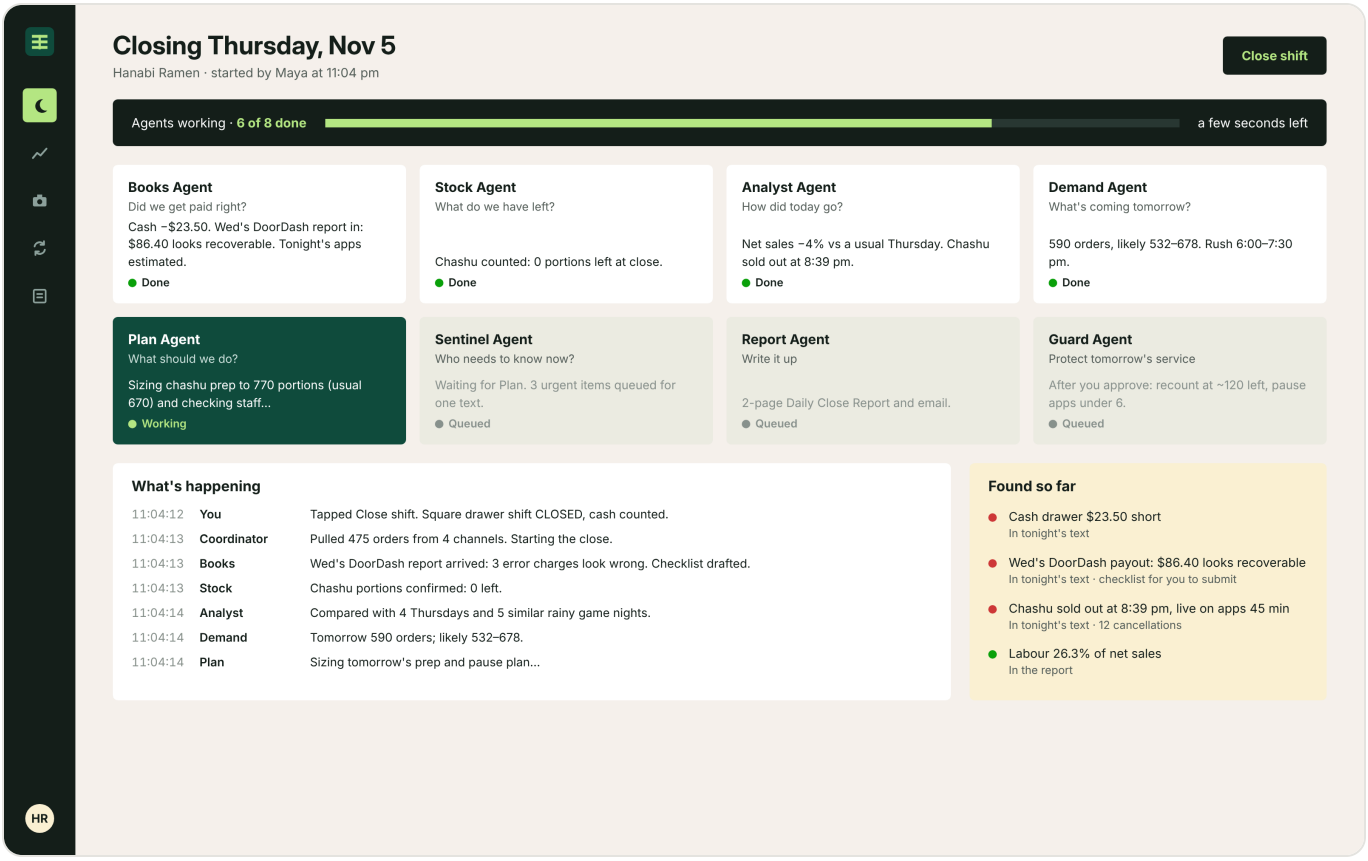


Closer app: optional walk-in video, count confirmation, and the owner's nightly briefing

ONE BUTTON CLOSES THE DAY

The manager taps Close shift. The agents do the rest

Instead of running sales, cash and fee reports by hand, the manager taps one button. Gondola's agents check the money, explain the day, plan tomorrow and write the report in a few seconds.



The close run screen · illustrative data

What triggers it

The Close shift button in Gondola. On tap, it reads the POS's own close: Square's cash drawer shift (ENDED or CLOSED, with expected and counted cash), or Toast's Close Out Day. If nobody taps, it runs at the POS's business-day cutoff (Toast defaults to 4 a.m.).

Tonight, then when reports land

The close runs in about 2 seconds (7 cold). Cash is checked tonight; app payouts are estimated tonight and verified when each report arrives: DoorDash the next evening, Uber Eats up to 72 hours, Grubhub when its export arrives.

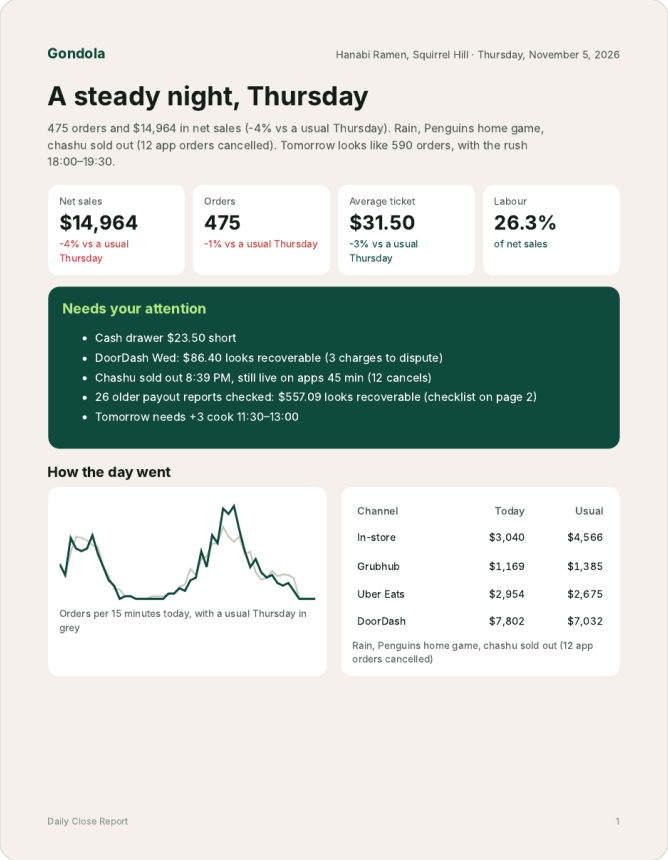
What the manager gets

One bundled text only when something is urgent, an email with the 2-page report, and tomorrow's card (prep per item, pause time per app) to approve in one tap. Everything stays askable.

THE DAILY CLOSE REPORT

Two pages that replace the end-of-day spreadsheet

Generated from the store's own data every night, as a PDF the owner can keep, forward or print. Stored 30 days, then rolled into a monthly summary; any day can be rebuilt from its saved findings.



Gondola

Hanabi Ramen, Squirrel Hill · Thursday, November 5, 2026

A steady night, Thursday

475 orders and $14,964 in net sales (-4% vs a usual Thursday). Rain, Penguins home game, chashu sold out (12 app orders cancelled). Tomorrow looks like 590 orders, with the rush 18:00–19:30.

Net sales	Orders	Average ticket	Labour
$14,964	475	$31.50	26.3%
-4% vs a usual Thursday	-1% vs a usual Thursday	-3% vs a usual Thursday	of net sales

Needs your attention

- Cash drawer $23.50 short
- DoorDash Wed: $86.40 looks recoverable (3 charges to dispute)
- Chashu sold out 8:39 PM, still live on apps 45 min (12 cancels)
- 26 older payout reports checked: $557.09 looks recoverable (checklist on page 2)
- Tomorrow needs +3 cook 11:30–13:00

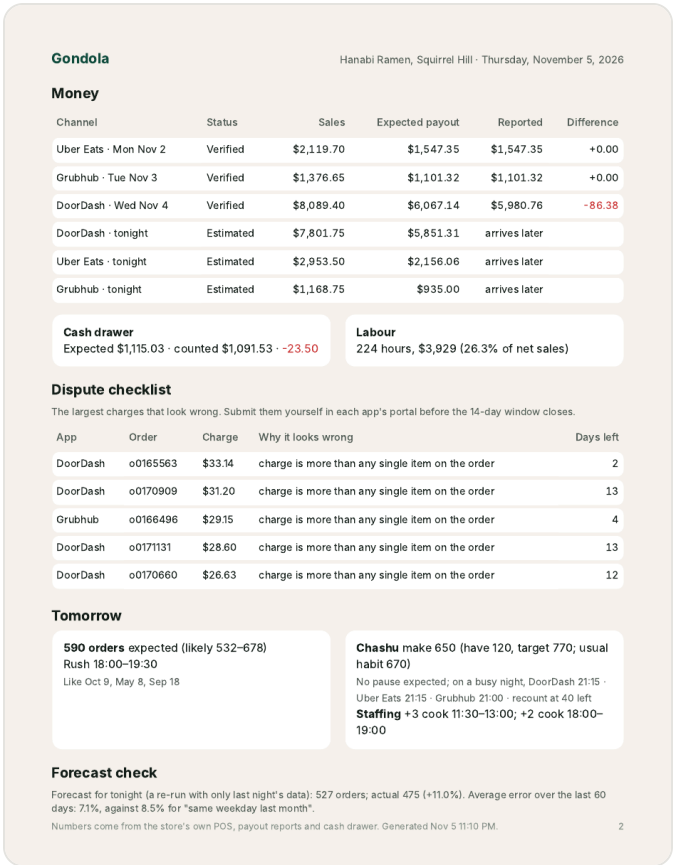
How the day went

Orders per 15 minutes today, with a usual Thursday in grey

Channel	Today	Usual
In-store	$3,040	$4,566
Grubhub	$1,169	$1,385
Uber Eats	$2,954	$2,675
DoorDash	$7,802	$7,032

Rain, Penguins home game, chashu sold out (12 app orders cancelled)

Daily Close Report 1



Gondola

Hanabi Ramen, Squirrel Hill · Thursday, November 5, 2026

Money

Channel	Status	Sales	Expected payout	Reported	Difference
Uber Eats · Mon Nov 2	Verified	$2,119.70	$1,547.35	$1,547.35	+0.00
Grubhub · Tue Nov 3	Verified	$1,376.65	$1,101.32	$1,101.32	+0.00
DoorDash · Wed Nov 4	Verified	$8,089.40	$6,067.14	$5,980.76	-86.38
DoorDash · tonight	Estimated	$7,801.75	$5,851.31	arrives later	
Uber Eats · tonight	Estimated	$2,953.50	$2,156.06	arrives later	
Grubhub · tonight	Estimated	$1,168.75	$935.00	arrives later	

Cash drawer
Expected $1,115.03 · counted $1,091.53 · -23.50

Labour
224 hours, $3,929 (26.3% of net sales)

Dispute checklist

The largest charges that look wrong. Submit them yourself in each app's portal before the 14-day window closes.

App	Order	Charge	Why it looks wrong	Days left
DoorDash	o0165563	$33.14	charge is more than any single item on the order	2
DoorDash	o0170909	$31.20	charge is more than any single item on the order	13
Grubhub	o0166496	$29.15	charge is more than any single item on the order	4
DoorDash	o0171131	$28.60	charge is more than any single item on the order	13
DoorDash	o0170660	$26.63	charge is more than any single item on the order	12

Tomorrow

590 orders expected (likely 532–678)
Rush 18:00–19:30
Like Oct 9, May 8, Sep 18

Chashu make 650 (have 120, target 770; usual habit 670)
No pause expected; on a busy night, DoorDash 21:15 · Uber Eats 21:15 · Grubhub 21:00 · recount at 40 left
Staffing +3 cook 11:30–13:00; +2 cook 18:00–19:00

Forecast check

Forecast for tonight (a re-run with only last night's data): 527 orders; actual 475 (+11.0%). Average error over the last 60 days: 7.1%, against 8.5% for "same weekday last month".

Numbers come from the store's own POS, payout reports and cash drawer. Generated Nov 5 11:10 PM. 2

Page 1 · The day

Net sales, orders, ticket and labour against a usual day; what needs attention; the rush curve and channels.

Page 2 · Money

Verified payouts for reports that arrived, tonight's estimates, the cash drawer, and the dispute checklist.

Page 2 · Tomorrow

Forecast with a likely range, prep per item, the safety net, and staffing gaps by hour.

Page 2 · Forecast check

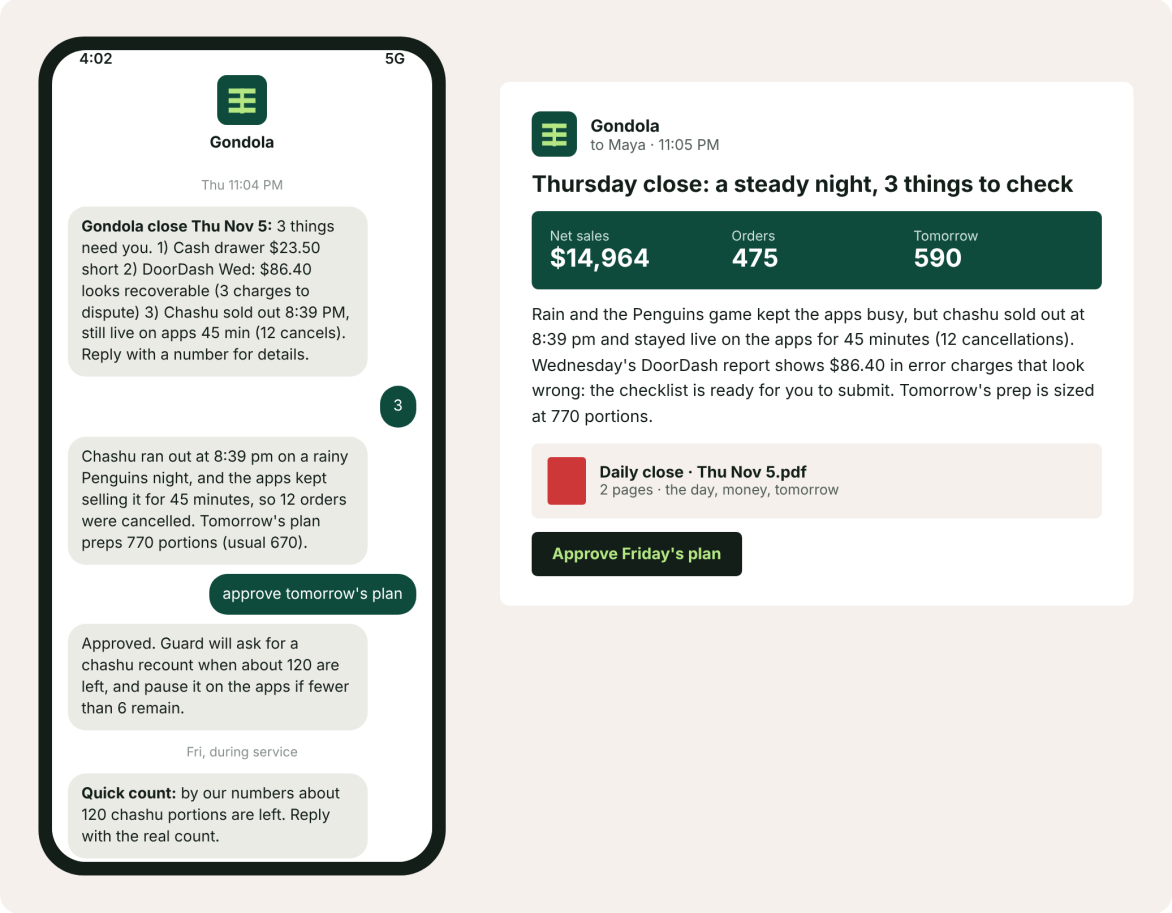
Last night's forecast against tonight's actual, and the 60-day error against same-weekday averages.

Sample report built from a synthetic year of data for a fictional Pittsburgh restaurant; the 2-page sample is in the project folder.

ALERTS

Only what's urgent reaches your phone

The Sentinel Agent sends one bundled text per close, and only when something is urgent: 14 of 47 nights in our replay. Everything else waits for the email or the dashboard. Managers can reply to ask a follow-up.



LEVEL	EXAMPLES	HOW IT'S SENT
Urgent	Cash short by more than $20; $75 or more recoverable on a payout report that just arrived; an item sold out while live on the apps (5+ cancels); cancellation rate crossing DoorDash's 1.1% goal; the close failed	One bundled SMS per close (Twilio)
Important	Older payout shortfalls and the dispute checklist, labour over target, usage running ahead of sales	Nightly email and report
For your information	Best sellers, forecast accuracy, small variances	Dashboard only

Quiet hours from 1 to 8 a.m. except for failures; one text per close, however many taps. US business texting needs a registered sender (A2P 10DLC vetting can take up to 5 business days) and opt-in, with STOP and HELP. A Twilio trial can't send custom text, so the demo uses a paid account with a Canadian number to the team's phones. Email goes through SendGrid.

ASK GONDOLA

Ask anything about the last 365 days

The Ask Agent is in charge of every metric. It answers in the dashboard or by text, always with numbers from the store's own history, and asks what you mean instead of guessing.

Questions it handles

- "How did we do on Super Bowl Sunday compared with a normal Sunday?"
- "Which item lost us the most money to cancellations this month?"
- "Are DoorDash fees eating more of our sales than in the summer?"
- "What would Gondola have predicted for last Friday, and how close was it?"
- "Show me nights like tomorrow."

How it answers

A metrics layer defines every number once (net sales, orders by channel, fees, labour %, food cost %, cancellations, minutes sold out, forecast error), with the exact formula. The agent picks metrics, dates and filters through typed tools; it never writes raw SQL. Every answer shows the numbers it used.

A year of history is also the test set

Backtests on demand

For any past day, Gondola re-runs the forecast using only data up to the night before, then compares it with what happened. That's how the report's forecast accuracy is measured.

Similar days

Each day is described by weekday, weather, events, holidays and promos. Gondola finds the past days most like tomorrow and shows how they went, so the forecast is explainable.

Context for every agent

The Analyst compares today with similar days, the Demand Agent learns from them, and the Sentinel knows what "unusual" means for this store.

ASK AGENT TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
`query_metric`	Any defined metric for a date range, grouped by day, hour, channel or item
`compare_periods`	Today vs a usual weekday, last week, last month or last year
`backtest_forecast`	What the forecast would have said for a past date, and its error
`find_similar_days`	The closest past days by weekday, weather, events and promos
`explain_change`	Breaks a change into channel, item and hour contributions
`make_chart`	Returns a chart for the dashboard, or a link by text

SERVICES & NIGHTLY PIPELINE

From Close shift to approved plan in seconds

Tapping Close shift starts the pipeline. Steps without dependencies run in parallel; every step writes to one shared database.

11:04 pm	+1 s	+1 s	+1 s	+1 s	+2 s	+2 s
Close shift Reads the POS shift and pulls the day's orders from every channel.	**Books** Cash tonight; verifies app reports that arrived.	**Stock** Confirmed portion counts for limited items.	**Analyze** Today vs usual and similar days.	**Forecast** Tomorrow's curve, items, drivers.	**Plan** Prep per item, pause time per app.	**Report & alert** PDF, email, one urgent text.

Each later night, Books verifies the app reports that have landed since (DoorDash next evening, Uber Eats up to 72 hours). During tomorrow's service the **Guard** counts sales, asks for one recount when about 120 portions are believed left, and pauses the item on the apps at the buffer.

SERVICE	WHAT IT DOES	RUNS
Close trigger	Button, POS shift close or business-day cutoff; starts one run per store per day and never runs twice for the same day	At close
Connectors	Orders from the POS or middleware (all apps), Report Builder imports, invoices by photo or email, weather and Pittsburgh events	At close + webhooks
Metrics layer	One definition per metric, computed into daily, hourly and item tables for the last 365 days	After ingest
Forecast models	LightGBM with weather, event, school and promo inputs plus holiday priors (Chronos-2 optional); backtests on any past day; similar-day search	Nightly
Optimizer	Prep and order quantities against the cost of running out; staffing needed per hour to stay under capacity	Nightly
Report renderer	Turns the agents' findings and charts into the Daily Close Report PDF, stored 30 days, then summarized monthly	Nightly
Notifier	SMS through Twilio and email through SendGrid, with quiet hours, retries and replies routed to the Ask Agent	On demand
Guard executor	Pauses an approved item on the apps (DoorDash item status, Square sold-out; others by partner access), sends the recount prompt, unpauses at close	Live in service

AGENTIC ORCHESTRATION

A coordinator and nine specialists, each with one job

Built with Google ADK. Each agent answers one question, owns its numbers, and hands a typed result to the next. Code, not agents, touches money and menus.

Trigger
Close shift button · POS shift close · business-day cutoff · a text from the manager

Shared tools
connectors, metrics layer, forecast models, optimizer, report renderer, notifier

Close Coordinator
Runs the close as a dependency graph, starts agents in parallel where it can, checks their results agree (stock vs sales, payouts vs orders), and retries or skips a step without failing the whole close.

Human gate
the manager approves tomorrow's card and submits any disputes

Deterministic executors
Guard executor and supplier drafts act only on approved items

Runs in four phases ↓

1 · Reconcile

Books Agent
Did we get paid right?

Stock Agent
What do we have left?

2 · Understand and prepare

Analyst Agent
How did today go?

Demand Agent
What's coming tomorrow?

Plan Agent
What should we do?

3 · Communicate

Report Agent
Write it up

Sentinel Agent
Who needs to know, and how fast?

4 · Protect and answer

Guard Agent
Keep tomorrow's service safe

Ask Agent
Anything about the last 365 days, any time

How a close runs

STEP	WHO AND WHAT
1 · Tap Close shift	Coordinator reads the POS shift, pulls orders from every channel, refreshes the metrics layer
2 · In parallel	Books checks cash and verifies arrived app reports · Stock takes portion counts · Demand forecasts tomorrow
3 · Understand	Analyst compares today with usual and similar days, using Books and Stock results
4 · Prepare	Plan turns Stock + Demand into tomorrow's card: prep per item, pause time per app, staffing gaps
5 · Check	Coordinator cross-checks: payouts match orders, prep fits staff hours, every at-risk item has a rule
6 · Communicate	Sentinel bundles the urgent findings into one text · Report writes the PDF and email · every number is checked against tool outputs first
7 · Approve and protect	Manager approves in one tap → Guard arms the safety net for tomorrow's service

AGENTIC ORCHESTRATION

What each agent does

AGENT	ITS ONE JOB	READS	TOOLS	PRODUCES
Close Coordinator	Run the close end to end, in the right order, and make sure the pieces agree	Trigger, run history	`start_step`, `check_consistency`	A complete, consistent close, or a clear note of what was skipped
Books	Did we get paid right? Match orders, fees, adjustments, payouts and cash	POS orders and shift, Report Builder exports, payout reports	`match_payouts`, `cash_variance`, `draft_dispute`	Cash tonight; apps verified as reports land; charges marked valid, review or disputable; a checklist to submit
Stock	What do we have left? Portions of 3–8 limited items	Manager's count at close, sales; optional recipes, invoices, video	`confirm_counts`, `update_ledger`, `parse_invoice`	Confirmed portions per item; optional ingredient ledger
Analyst	How did today go, and why?	Metrics layer (365 days), Books and Stock results	`compare_periods`, `find_similar_days`, `explain_change`	Findings with numbers, ranked by impact
Demand	What's coming tomorrow?	History, weather, Pittsburgh events, promos	`run_forecast`, `backtest_forecast`, `find_similar_days`	15-minute curve, item demand, drivers, likely range
Plan	What should we do about it?	Stock + Demand, schedule, supplier list	`optimize_prep`, `pause_plan`, `staff_gap`, `draft_order`	Tomorrow's card: prep per item, pause time per app; staffing gaps
Report	Write it up so a busy owner gets it in 60 seconds	All findings	`render_report`, `make_chart`	2-page Daily Close Report and email summary
Sentinel	Who needs to know, and how fast?	All findings, manager preferences, quiet hours	`score_urgency`, `send_sms`, `send_email`	One bundled text per close when urgent; the rest in the email
Guard	Keep tomorrow's service safe	Live orders, confirmed counts, the approved card	`check_runout`, `ask_recount`, `set_item_unavailable`	A recount prompt near 120 believed left; timed app pauses
Ask	Answer anything about the business, any time	Metrics layer (365 days), all agents' outputs	`query_metric`, `compare_periods`, `backtest_forecast`, `make_chart`	Answers with the numbers used, in the dashboard or by text

Rules every agent follows

- **Numbers come from tools.** Every number an agent writes is checked against tool outputs before it's sent; LLMs never own money sentences.
- **Agents propose, code acts.** Money, menus and supplier orders change only through executors, after approval.
- **One owner per number.** Books owns money, Stock owns ingredients, Demand owns forecasts, so agents never disagree silently.
- **Fail soft.** If one step fails, the close still finishes and the report says what's missing.

TECH STACK

Python-first, with AI where it counts

LAYER	TOOLS	WHY
Agents	Google ADK: a coordinator plus nine specialists; a pinned Gemini or Claude model (paid tier) with tool calling and a number guardrail on every reply	Typed hand-offs, parallel steps, approval gates
Metrics layer	Metric definitions in YAML, computed with pandas and DuckDB over Parquet (365 days)	One definition per number, so agents and reports agree
Forecasting	LightGBM with weather, event and promo inputs and holiday priors; Chronos-2 optional; conformal ranges from rolling backtests; similar-day search	Beats same-weekday averages: 8.1% vs 9.1% daily error (120-day backtest, synthetic year)
Optimization	NumPy Monte Carlo, stockout-cost-aware par levels, OR-Tools CP-SAT for prep timing and staffing gaps	Prep and staff sized to a busy night
Reconciliation	pandas matching of orders, fees, adjustments and payouts per channel as each report arrives; Square cash drawer shifts	Finds what each app owes, without portal logins
Documents	Multimodal LLM extraction for invoices and receipts, validated against totals	Feeds the stock ledger without typing
Reports	Jinja2 HTML templates with SVG charts, rendered to PDF by headless Chromium (Playwright)	A polished PDF every night, no design tool needed
Notifications	Twilio Programmable Messaging (two-way SMS, verified sender), SendGrid email, replies routed to the Ask Agent	Reaches managers wherever they are
Backend	FastAPI, websockets for the live close screen, asyncio workers, APScheduler (Airflow in production)	One Python codebase from API to models
Data	Postgres (live state), DuckDB + Parquet (history, backtests), Cloud Storage (reports expire after 30 days)	Fast analytics with little ops
Integrations	Square sandbox incl. cash drawer shifts (real); DoorDash test stores for item pause (if granted); Uber, Grubhub and middleware (mocked); Report Builder CSV; Open-Meteo; Ticketmaster	Real where open, faithful mocks where gated
Front end	Next.js + Tailwind, hand-built SVG charts, mobile web for the closer	The visuals judges see

Why it can't be vibe-coded in a weekend

- **Nine agents that agree.** Typed results, one owner per number, and a coordinator that cross-checks before anything is sent.
- **Reconciliation that holds up:** fees, adjustments and payouts matched per order across four channels and the cash drawer.
- **Tested:** full close in about 2 s warm and 7 s cold, 47 of 47 nights in a replay, and an independent QA pass that found 23 issues (19 fixed).
- **Alerts people trust:** one bundled text per close, quiet hours, de-duplication and two-way SMS that stays compliant.

SYSTEM DESIGN

One close, one database, many services

Every source lands in one Postgres schema and a 365-day metrics layer, so the report, the alerts and the Ask Agent always quote the same numbers.

Sources

Close shift
Gondola button, Square drawer shift, Toast Close Out Day, or cutoff

POS or middleware
orders from every app plus in-store, catalog, labour

DoorDash Report Builder
sales and payout history (CSV, 2 years)

Invoices and recipes
photos, forwarded email, AI-drafted recipes

Context
weather, Pittsburgh events, holidays, promos

Manager
approvals, texts back, questions

Gondola core · FastAPI + workers

Close Coordinator
dependency graph, parallel steps, cross-checks, one run per day

Reconcile
Books and Stock agents over connectors and the ledger

Understand and prepare
Analyst, Demand and Plan agents over the metrics layer, forecasts and optimizer

Communicate
Report Agent + renderer; Sentinel Agent + notifier

Protect
Guard Agent, rule engine, executor with idempotency keys

Ask
conversational analyst over typed metric tools

Outputs

Close run screen
live progress

Daily Close Report
PDF + email

One urgent text
Twilio SMS, two-way

Card to approve
prep per item, pause time per app

Timed pauses
per app, with partner access

Event bus: Redis Streams (hackathon) → Kafka or Pub/Sub (production)

Postgres
stores, menu-to-channel IDs, recipes, ledger, orders, payouts, findings, plans, rules, alerts, action log

Metrics layer
DuckDB + Parquet: 365 days of daily, hourly and item metrics, backtests, similar-day index

Report bucket
Daily Close Reports for 30 days, then rolled into monthly summaries; invoice images, video keyframes (7 days)

Design decisions

- **Agents propose, code executes.** No model writes money, menus or supplier orders; executors act only on approved items.
- **Idempotent close.** Tapping twice or a retry never double-counts; each run is keyed to store and business date.
- **Money checked when it lands.** Cash at close; each app's payout verified when its report arrives; disputes are a checklist, never filed by Gondola.
- **Compliant messaging.** One verified sender, opt-in, STOP and HELP, quiet hours; no customer data in texts.
- **Per-store isolation.** Platform tokens in a secret manager; row-level security per store.
- **No audio, ever.** The optional walk-in video records with the microphone off (Pennsylvania all-party consent).

How it connects, what's real, and where it goes

How Gondola connects, by merchant setup

MERCHANT SETUP	CLOSE TRIGGER AND ORDERS	SOLD-OUT UPDATES REACH DOORDASH THROUGH
Square	Close shift reads the cash drawer shift; orders from the Square API	Square sold-out (all channels at once); per-app pause needs DoorDash partner access
Toast or Clover	Close Out Day or the business-day cutoff; orders from the POS API	The POS's stock API (Toast write access after certification)
Middleware (Deliverect, Otter)	Close shift button; the middleware's order feed	Per-channel pause and busy API (partner access)
Tablet only	Close shift button; Report Builder exports	A one-tap prompt to the closer on the tablet

Real vs mocked

WORKING IN THE TEST REPO	TO WIRE BEFORE DEMO DAY	MOCKED FROM DOCUMENTED SCHEMAS
All ten agents' tools and the coordinator · metrics layer over a synthetic year · forecasting and backtests · the card and Guard with recount · 2-page report and bucket · number guardrail · bundled text (written to an outbox)	Square sandbox orders and cash drawer shifts · item pause on DoorDash test stores (if granted) · Twilio SMS (paid account, Canadian number) · SendGrid email · LLM wording through the ADK graph	Uber Eats, Grubhub and middleware calls · DoorDash payout report (CSV in the documented format) · live order stream (replayed from the demo year) · supplier ordering

Demo in 2.5 minutes

1 · Close. A judge taps Close shift on the Square sandbox store. The close run screen lights up agent by agent while the log streams what each one finds.

2 · Buzz. Seconds later the team's phone gets one text: cash drawer $23.50 short, $86.40 recoverable on Wednesday's DoorDash report, chashu sold out at 8:39 PM and stayed live on the apps for 45 minutes. The 2-page report lands in email.

3 · Ask. The judge texts back "why did we run out?" and gets the answer with numbers. Then, on the dashboard: "How did we do on Super Bowl Sunday?" and "What would you have predicted for last Friday?"

4 · Protect. They approve Friday's card: 590 orders expected (likely 532–678), rush 6:00–7:30 pm, 770 chashu portions. A replayed night shows the recount prompt, then chashu pausing on the apps instead of selling out live. In a 90-day replay of historical orders, store-caused app cancellations fell from 294 to 0–6 with a recount (5–10% count error, pause delay up to 5 min); without it, a 5% count error made things worse.

What's next

Bank feed

Match payouts to actual deposits, so Books closes the loop to the bank.

Schedule

Turn the staffing gaps into shift offers, with swaps handled by text.

DoorDash partnership

Reporting API and Marketplace partner access, then a hand-off to DoorDash Assistant.